

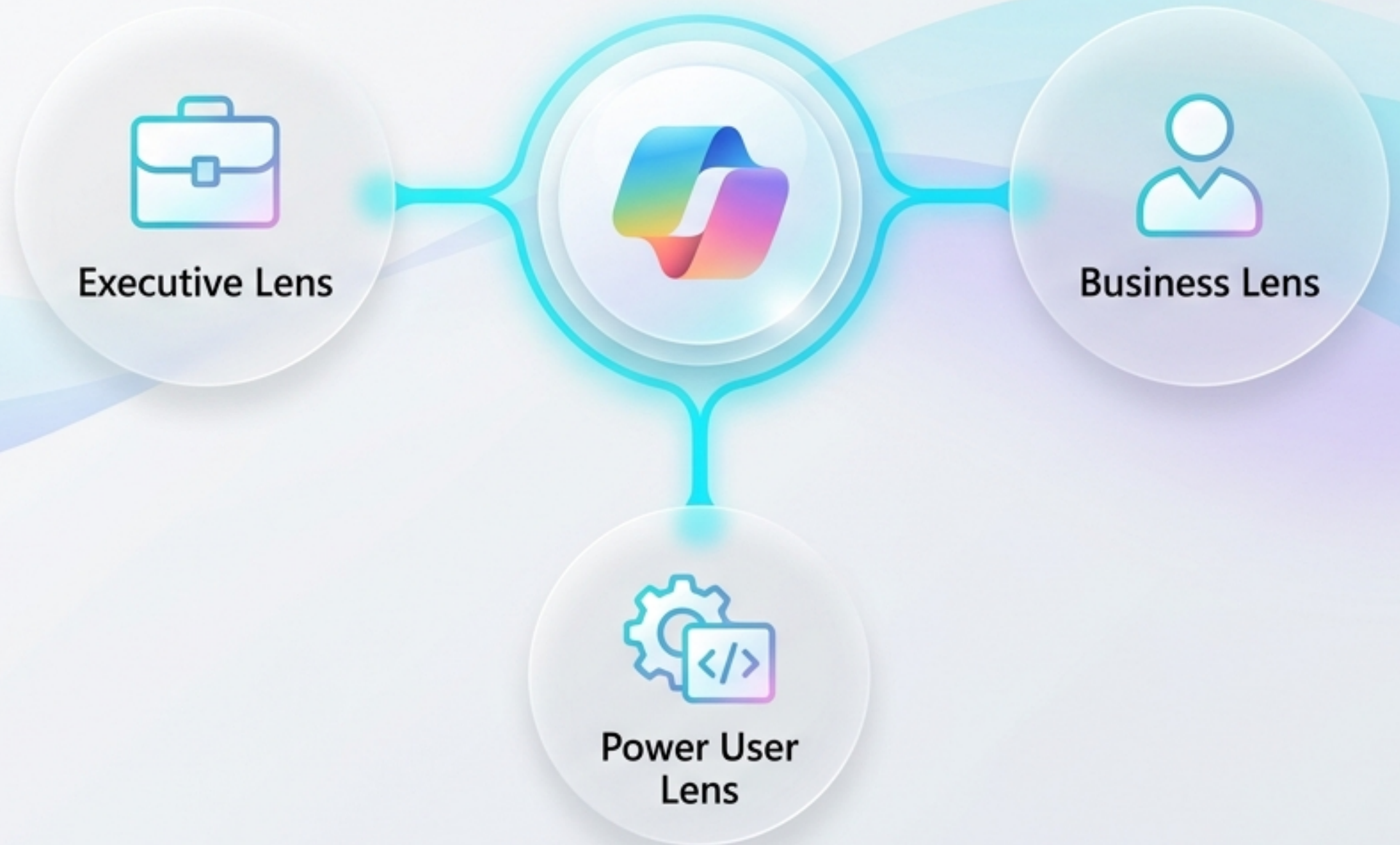
Demystifying Microsoft Copilot Studio

One Platform. Infinite Possibilities.
A guide for Business, IT, and
Executive Leaders.

October 2026 Edition

One Platform, Three Different Lenses

Microsoft Copilot Studio is a comprehensive conversational AI platform. But its true value depends entirely on who is looking at it.



Bridging the gap between secure governance, everyday productivity, and advanced technical control.

The Copilot Persona Matrix



C-Level Lens (The Strategist)

**Is it worth it
and is it safe?**

- ✓ ROI & Business Value
- ✓ Predictable Costs
- ✓ Strict Data Governance



Business User Lens (The Optimizer)

**Can it make my
daily work easier?**

- ✓ Natural Language Building
- ✓ Saving Time
- ✓ Automating Repetitive Tasks



Power User Lens (The Architect)

**How far can I
extend it?**

- ✓ API Connections
- ✓ Advanced Orchestration
- ✓ Consumption Monitoring

Secure, Scalable, and Governed AI



Data Protection: Built-in Data Loss Prevention (DLP) restricts connector usage and ensures sensitive company data never leaks.



Environment Routing: Keep data strictly contained within specific geographic regions or departments to meet regulatory compliance.



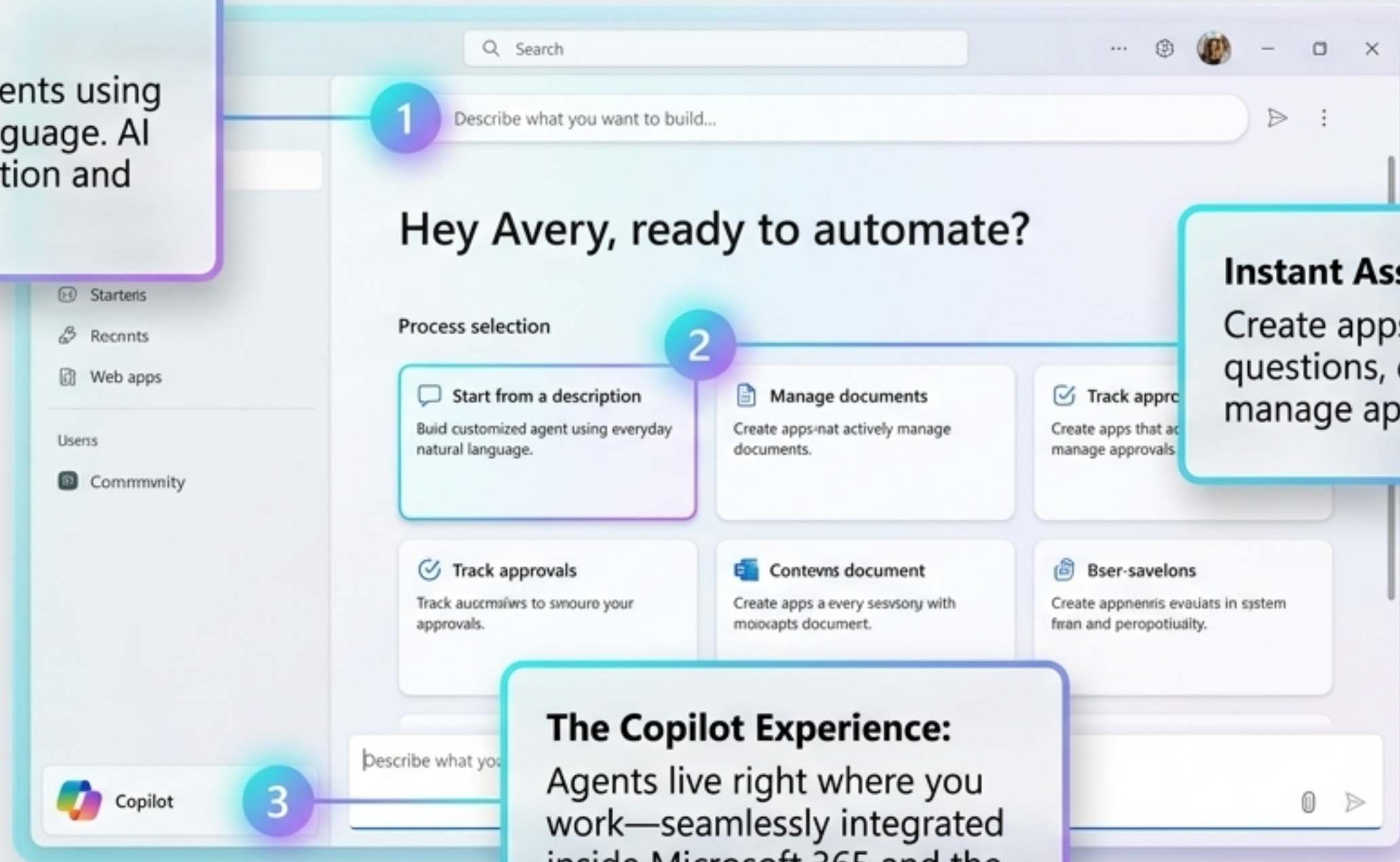
Managed Environments: Total administrative visibility over what is being built, who is sharing agents, and how capacity is being consumed across the tenant.



If You Can Describe It, You Can Build It

No Code Required:

Build customized agents using everyday natural language. AI assists in the generation and iteration.



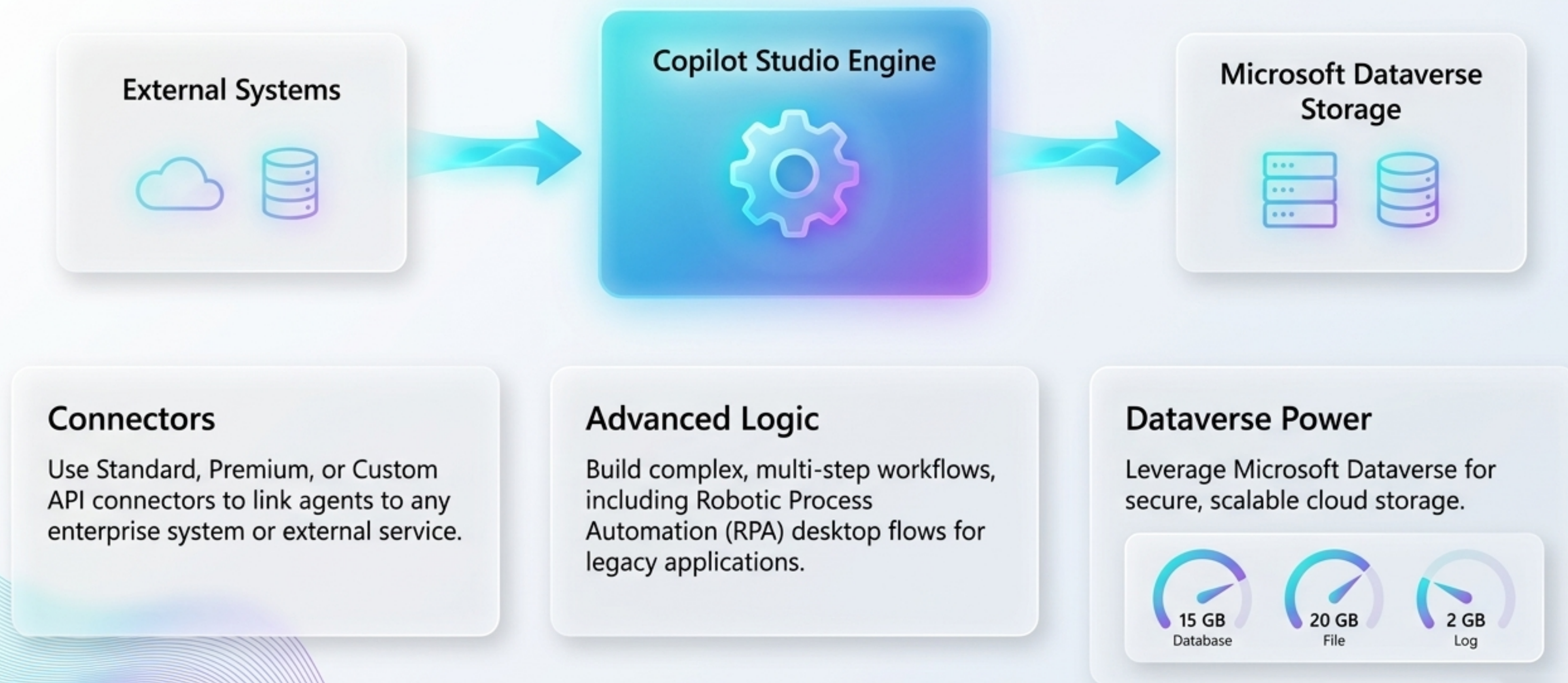
Instant Assistance:

Create apps that actively answer questions, draft documents, or manage approvals.

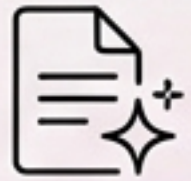
The Copilot Experience:

Agents live right where you work—seamlessly integrated inside Microsoft 365 and the Copilot ecosystem.

Connect, Orchestrate, and Extend



Copilot Studio in Action



Business User - HR Assistant

"What is our travel policy?"

An agent connects to company SharePoint documents to instantly answer employee HR questions securely.



Power User - IT Automator

"Reset my password."

An agent integrated with the IT ticketing system walks a user through a defined, secure password reset flow without human intervention.



C-Level - Exec Dashboard

"Show me Q3 projections."

An agent pulls live, governed data from Dynamics 365 to instantly generate a secure, summarized report for leadership.

The Secret to Smart AI: The Harness



AI Model
(The Intelligence)



The Harness
(The Operating Structure)



Valuable Action

The brain alone isn't enough to do useful work. It needs a surrounding system that tells it how to reason, what tools to use, what information it can access, and how to act. That surrounding system is the **Harness**.

Choosing the Right Harness for the Job



GitHub Copilot Harness

Build & Automate

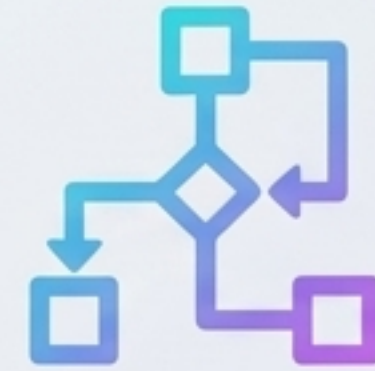
The builder mode. Describe the outcome, and AI helps build the end-to-end agent or workflow process.



Copilot Chat Harness

Ask & Assist

The assistant mode. Create agents that extend Microsoft Copilot with your specific organization's knowledge.



Standard Harness

Define & Execute

The controlled mode. Build rule-based conversational agents where you define the exact topics, rules, and conversational paths step-by-step.

Copilot Credits: The Unit of Consumption



Copilot Studio runs on "Credits."

Think of them as the energy required to run your AI agents.

High Drain

Complex Applications
(AI Generation, Reasoning,
Work IQ APIs)



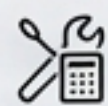
Consumes More
Credits

Low Drain

Simple, Predefined
Standard Flows



Consumes Fewer
Credits



Use the built-in Copilot Credit Estimator to forecast volume, and monitor usage directly in the Power Platform Admin Center.

Flexible Purchasing for Any Stage of the Journey



The Taxi Meter

Pay-As-You-Go (\$0.01 / Credit)

Use it first, pay for what you actually use. Best for unpredictable or experimental usage.



The Wholesale Model

Copilot Credit Pre-Purchase Plan (P3)

Buy in bulk upfront (Tiers from 300,000+ credits) for a discounted rate. Best for consistently high usage.



The Company Wallet

Microsoft Agent Pre-Purchase Plan (P3)

A unified pool of Agent Commit Units (ACUs) shared across Copilot Studio and Microsoft Foundry. Best for large enterprises.



The Mobile Data Plan

Capacity Packs (\$200 / month)

A fixed monthly bundle containing 25,000 Credits. Best for highly predictable, pre-planned capacity.

Other ways to build

Create agents that extend Microsoft 365 Copilot, or build agents and agents.

Start Building Your Copilot Today

One platform. Tailored for every role.
Built on secure Microsoft architecture.

1. Sign up for a free
Microsoft Copilot Studio Trial.

2. Utilize the Copilot Credit
Estimator to forecast your
use cases.

3. Consult with your Microsoft
Certified Partner to align the
right purchasing plan to your
business goals.